

Ideation Phase
Brainstorm & Idea Prioritization

Date	1 July 2026
Team ID	---
Project Name	AI-POWERED CUSTOMER SUPPORT & SERVICE AUTOMATION
Maximum Marks	4 Marks

2. IDEATION PHASE

2.1 Introduction

The ideation phase is one of the most important stages in the Software Development Life Cycle (SDLC). It focuses on understanding the business problem, identifying customer pain points, gathering stakeholder requirements, and proposing an effective solution before the actual development begins.

For an international Electronics & Gadgets company, customer support plays a significant role in maintaining customer satisfaction and brand reputation. As the company expands globally, the number of customer inquiries regarding product issues, warranty claims, order tracking, returns, and technical assistance continues to grow. Traditional manual customer support processes are no longer sufficient to efficiently handle these increasing requests.

The AI-Powered Customer Support & Service Automation system was conceptualized to eliminate repetitive manual tasks and improve service quality through automation and artificial intelligence. By leveraging Salesforce Service Cloud, Salesforce Flows, and Agentforce, the proposed solution provides intelligent case management, automated workflows, and AI-assisted customer interactions within a centralized platform.

This chapter presents the business problem, stakeholder analysis, customer journey, empathy map, brainstorming process, and proposed solution that guided the development of the system.

2.2 Business Problem

The company currently manages customer service requests manually. Customers contact the support team through email, phone calls, or web forms for various issues such as product defects, warranty registration, order tracking, and technical support.

Support agents manually review each request, create service records, assign cases, communicate with customers, and update the case status. As the number of customer requests increases, manual operations become inefficient and difficult to manage.

The major problems identified include:

- High volume of customer support requests.
- Delayed response and resolution times.
- Manual case assignment to support agents.
- Repetitive administrative tasks.
- Inconsistent responses from different agents.
- Lack of centralized customer information.
- Difficulty tracking warranty claims.
- Poor visibility into team performance.
- Delayed escalation of unresolved cases.
- Limited reporting and analytics.

These issues negatively affect customer satisfaction, increase operational costs, and reduce

2.3 Stakeholder Analysis

The success of the AI-Powered Customer Support & Service Automation system depends on several stakeholders who interact with the application throughout the customer service lifecycle.

Stakeholder	Role	Responsibilities
Customer	End User	Submit support requests, warranty claims, and order inquiries.
Support Agent	Service Representative	Handle customer cases, communicate with customers, and resolve issues.
Warranty Team	Specialized Support	Verify warranty eligibility and process warranty claims.
Service Manager	Supervisor	Monitor agent performance, assign workloads, and review reports.
Salesforce Administrator	System Administrator	Configure Salesforce objects, automation, users, permissions, and security.
AI Service Agent (Agentforce)	Virtual Assistant	Answer customer queries, recommend solutions, and assist support agents.

2.4 Customer Pain Points

The current customer support process creates several challenges for both customers and employees.

Customer Pain Points

- Long waiting time before receiving responses.
- Difficulty tracking order status.
- Delayed warranty approvals.
- Repeating the same issue multiple times.
- Inconsistent support experience.
- Lack of transparency in case progress.

Support Agent Pain Points

- Manual case creation.
- Large number of repetitive tasks.
- Difficulty prioritizing urgent cases.
- High workload.
- Searching multiple systems for customer information.
- Delayed communication between departments.

Manager Pain Points

- Limited visibility into case performance.
- Difficulty measuring agent productivity.
- Manual report preparation.
- No real-time dashboards.
- Poor SLA monitoring.